

String Quartet Reduction

Music21

Carlo Gesualdo
(1560-1613)
Aestimatus sum

Violin I

Violin II

Viola

Violoncello

The first system of the score, measures 1-4, is written for Violin I, Violin II, Viola, and Violoncello. The key signature is two sharps (F# and C#) and the time signature is 3/2. The music begins with a whole rest in Violin I. In measure 2, Violin I enters with a half note G4, followed by a half note A4 in measure 3, and a half note B4 in measure 4. Violin II enters in measure 2 with a half note G4, followed by a half note A4 in measure 3, and a half note B4 in measure 4. The Viola and Violoncello enter in measure 2 with a half note G3, followed by a half note A3 in measure 3, and a half note B3 in measure 4. The system concludes with a double bar line and repeat signs.

5

Vln

Vln

Vla

Vc

The second system of the score, measures 5-8, continues the music for Violin I, Violin II, Viola, and Violoncello. The key signature remains two sharps and the time signature is 3/2. The system begins with a measure rest labeled '5'. In measure 6, Violin I plays a half note C5, followed by a half note D5 in measure 7, and a half note E5 in measure 8. Violin II plays a half note C5, followed by a half note D5 in measure 7, and a half note E5 in measure 8. The Viola plays a half note C4, followed by a half note D4 in measure 7, and a half note E4 in measure 8. The Violoncello plays a half note C3, followed by a half note D3 in measure 7, and a half note E3 in measure 8. The system concludes with a double bar line and repeat signs.

9

Vln

Vln

Vla

Vc

The third system of the score, measures 9-12, continues the music for Violin I, Violin II, Viola, and Violoncello. The key signature remains two sharps and the time signature is 3/2. The system begins with a measure rest labeled '9'. In measure 10, Violin I plays a half note F#5, followed by a half note G#5 in measure 11, and a half note A5 in measure 12. Violin II plays a half note F#5, followed by a half note G#5 in measure 11, and a half note A5 in measure 12. The Viola plays a half note F#4, followed by a half note G#4 in measure 11, and a half note A4 in measure 12. The Violoncello plays a half note F#3, followed by a half note G#3 in measure 11, and a half note A3 in measure 12. The system concludes with a double bar line and repeat signs.

14

Astiterunt reges - Gesualdo

First system of the musical score, measures 14-18. It features four staves: Violin I (Vln), Violin II (Vln), Viola (Vla), and Violoncello (Vc). The key signature is two sharps (F# and C#). The time signature is 3/2. The music is characterized by complex, chromatic melodic lines and frequent accidentals.

19

Second system of the musical score, measures 19-23. The instrumentation remains the same. The time signature changes to 2/2. The music continues with intricate chromatic patterns and rests.

24

Third system of the musical score, measures 24-27. The instrumentation remains the same. The time signature is 2/2. The music features rapid sixteenth-note passages in the strings.

28

Versus

Fourth system of the musical score, measures 28-31. The instrumentation remains the same. The time signature changes to 3/2. The section is marked 'Versus' and features a mix of chromatic and diatonic passages.

33

Violin I (Vln) and Violin II (Vln) parts in treble clef with key signature of two sharps (F# and C#). Viola (Vla) part in alto clef with key signature of two sharps. Violoncello (Vc) part in bass clef with key signature of two sharps. The music consists of six measures. Measures 33-34 show active melodic lines in all parts. Measures 35-37 feature a whole rest in the first violin part, while the other instruments continue their melodic development.

38

Continuation of the musical score for measures 38-43. Measures 38-39 show a change in the first violin part, which now has a whole rest. Measures 40-43 show a more active role for the first violin, with a melodic line that concludes with a half note. The other instruments continue their melodic lines, with the cello part featuring a long, sustained note in measure 43.

44

Factus sum.

Continuation of the musical score for measures 44-48. Measures 44-45 show a change in the first violin part, which now has a whole rest. Measures 46-48 show a more active role for the first violin, with a melodic line that concludes with a half note. The other instruments continue their melodic lines, with the cello part featuring a long, sustained note in measure 48.